

2025 LLM Usage Landscape

Real-World Data from OpenRouter

Audience: LLM industry professionals (R&D, product, investment)

Data window: Most recent week of March 2025 (OpenRouter Rankings)

Focus: market usage, competitive dynamics, and emerging trends

Headline signal

Weekly token usage rose from ~2T to ~26T in one year, indicating rapid demand expansion.

This Week's Top 10 Models

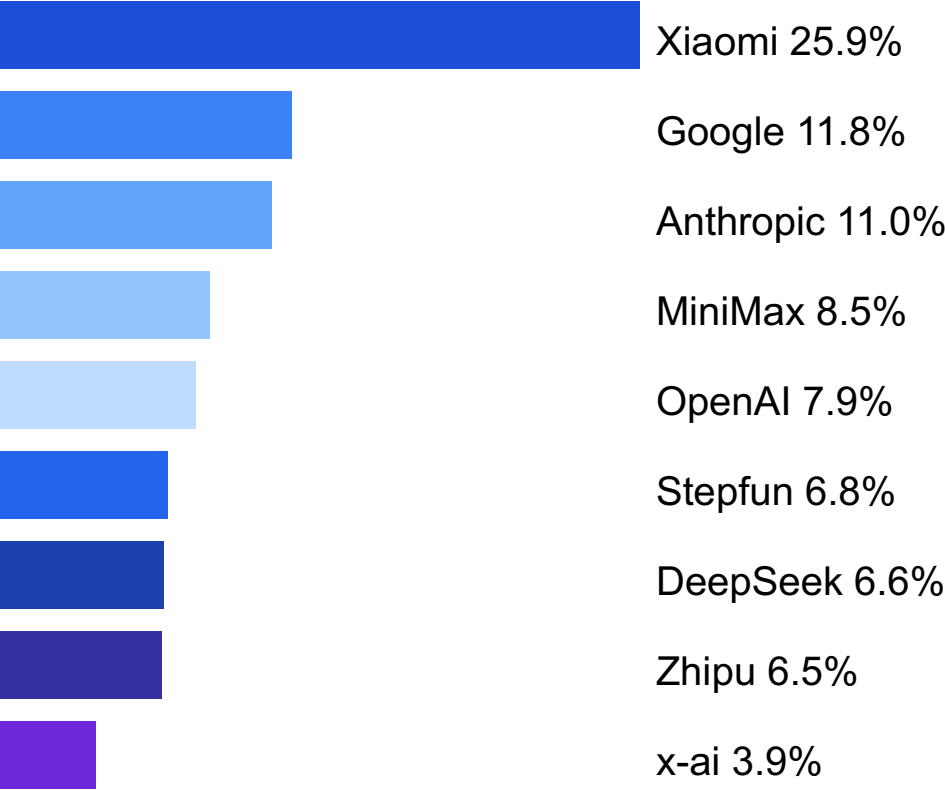
Ranking by weekly token usage (March 2025, OpenRouter)

Rank	Model	Provider	Weekly Token Usage	WoW
1	MiMo-V2-Pro	Xiaomi	3.96T	+165%
2	Step 3.5 Flash (free)	Stepfun	1.49T	+1%
3	MiniMax M2.7	MiniMax	1.29T	+253%
4	DeepSeek V3.2	DeepSeek	1.24T	+9%
5	Claude Sonnet 4.6	Anthropic	1.04T	-0%
6	Claude Opus 4.6	Anthropic	995B	+2%
7	Gemini 3 Flash Preview	Google	972B	+3%
8	GLM 5 Turbo	Zhipu (z-ai)	968B	-6%
9	MiniMax M2.5	MiniMax	909B	-30%
10	Grok 4.1 Fast	x-ai	599B	+32%

Chinese providers take 6 of top 10 slots; Xiaomi leads strongly.

Provider Market Share (by Token Volume)

Weekly share distribution from OpenRouter rankings



Key Readouts

- Xiaomi leads at 25.9%
- Chinese providers total $\approx 54.3\%$
- OpenAI at 7.9% (#5)
- No provider exceeds 30%

China's Breakthrough in Global LLM Competition

Evidence from OpenRouter international usage data

6 / 10 Top Models

from Chinese providers

≈54.3% Provider Share

Xiaomi + MiniMax + Stepfun +
DeepSeek + Zhipu combined

Competitive Interpretation

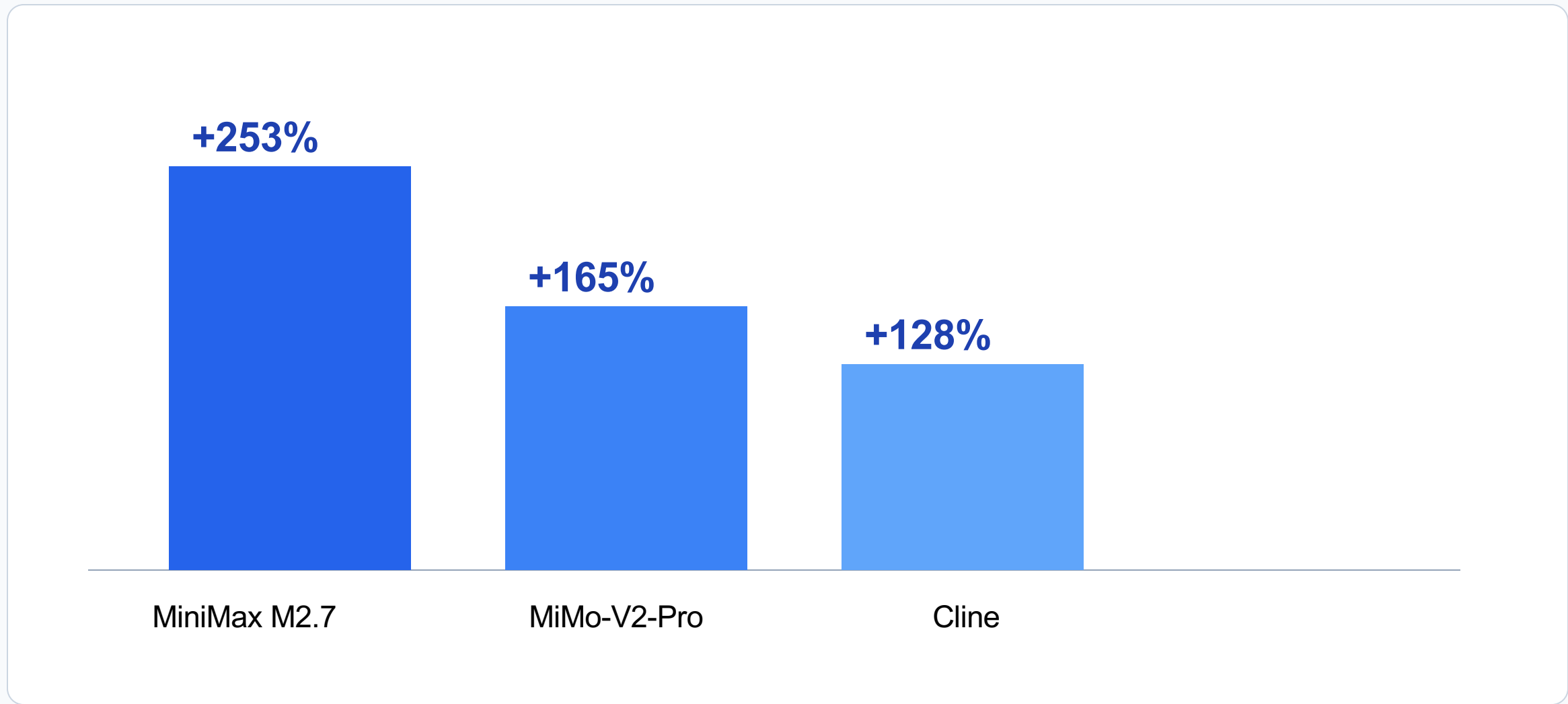
- Cost-performance wins global demand
- Fast deployment cycles improve traction
- Open platform access accelerates adoption

Strategic implications for incumbents

- 1) Price/latency optimization is now as critical as benchmark leadership.
- 2) Distribution through developer tools may be more decisive than brand alone.
- 3) Regional challengers can scale quickly when APIs are globally reachable.

This Week's Rising Stars: Fastest-Growing Models

WoW momentum highlights where demand is accelerating



Drivers suggested by usage context: strong cost-performance, coding-agent integration, and rapid iteration cycles.

App Ecosystem: Who's Calling These Models

Top applications by daily token consumption

1. OpenClaw — 829B
2. Kilo Code — 271B
3. Claude Code — 78B
4. Cline — 69.1B
5. Janitor AI — 29.2B
6. ISEKAI ZERO — 28.8B
7. Descript — 27B
8. Hermes Agent — 19.2B
9. Roo Code — 11.8B
10. Scripty — 9.95B

Pattern

Top 4 apps are all coding tools.

Signal

AI coding agents are the largest LLM use case.

Scale

OpenClaw is ~3× Kilo Code volume.

Key Insights and Industry Implications

1) Chinese models now hold dominant global usage share.

Combined provider share is about 54.3%; six of the top ten models are Chinese.

2) AI coding agents are the largest LLM consumption scenario.

The top four apps by daily token volume are all coding-focused.

3) Competition is fragmented with no outright winner.

No provider exceeds 30% share; top 10 models span eight providers.

4) Flash/Turbo models outperform flagships in adoption.

Real-world demand favors speed and affordability over peak benchmark performance.